

VARSHA SATHYANARANAN

AI Product Engineer

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CONTACT

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EDUCATION

Humber College, Longo School of Business

Graduate Certificate in Fashion Management

Toronto, Canada | Sept 2023, Aug 2024

National Institute of Fashion Technology NIFT

Bachelor of Design, Fashion Design

Chennai, India | July 2016, July 2020

SKILLS

Core Competencies:OTB & Assortment Planning · Fashion Buying & Category Management · PO/PI Coordination & Vendor Management · Inventory Control & Forecasting · TNA Calendar Tracking · Product Lifecycle Management (PLM) · Order Tracking & Sell-Through AnalysisTools:Advanced MS Excel (VLOOKUP, Pivot Tables, Dashboards) · MS Word · Google Sheets · Canva · Meta Ads Manager · SAP (PO/Inventory Tracking - Basic)Functional Strengths:Cross-Functional Collaboration · Trend Analysis & Data-Driven Decision-Making · Sales Performance Reporting · Catalog & Content Management · E-commerce Marketing · Vendor Negotiation & Cost Optimization

PROFILE

Commercial merchandiser with 4+ years of experience in buying, assortment planning, and P&L management across omnichannel retail. Proven track record of scaling categories from zero to ₹3.5 lakh revenue in 2 months, improving margins from 22% to 35% through vendor negotiation, and reducing stock-outs by 20% via data-driven assortment optimization. Skilled in OTB planning, vendor management across 20+ suppliers, and advanced Excel for dashboards and WIP tracking. Ready to drive sell-through and vendor compliance for fast-fashion womenswear in a fast-paced omnichannel environment.

EXPERIENCE

Category Manager - Fashion SuperK, Bangalore, India Nov 2025 - Present

Built the fashion category from near zero across online channels and a tech-enabled retail network of 3+ company-owned stores, launching assortments across apparel, footwear, and accessories while driving vendor expansion, category P&L ownership, and data-led merchandising decisions.

- Expanded the fashion assortment from 5 to 25+ subcategories across menswear, womenswear, kidswear, footwear, and accessories by onboarding 12+ regional vendors, identifying assortment gaps, and benchmarking category offerings against value retail players like DMart and Vishal Mega Mart.
- Generated ₹3.5 lakh in category revenue within two months by analyzing weekly sales performance, pricing benchmarks, and customer demand signals.
- Negotiated vendor pricing, MOQs, and sourcing terms, improving product margins from 22% to 35% while maintaining competitive retail pricing.
- Partnered with marketing teams to launch fashion-led campaigns during New Year, Pongal and Republic Day, increasing category visibility by ~22% and driving ~15% uplift in campaign period sales.
- Collaborated with operations and supply chain teams to improve stock availability for fast-moving SKUs, coordinating warehouse invoicing and inventory flow to reduce stock-outs by ~20% across priority products.
- Tracked sell-through, AOV, and margin performance using Excel and Metabase dashboards; identified underperforming SKUs and implemented assortment rationalization that improved category gross margin by ~6%.

Founder The Style Gram, Remote - Chennai, India Nov 2024 - Jun 2025

Built and operated a lean fashion reselling brand focused on affordable women's western-wear, managing end-to-end sourcing, merchandising, content creation, and customer engagement across Instagram and Swiggy Minis.

- Generated ₹50,000 in revenue during the launch phase with an average order value of ₹600, fulfilling 80+ customer orders across Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities with zero product returns.
- Sourced and merchandised 60+ SKUs across tops, skirts, and dresses through direct supplier negotiations, maintaining 45% gross margins and reducing sourcing turnaround time by 25%.
- Evaluated and engaged 5 supplier partners before finalizing a primary vendor to optimize pricing, quality consistency, and procurement turnaround time.
- Executed pricing, merchandising, and inventory tracking through Excel-based systems, ensuring 100% order fulfillment and streamlined stock management.
- Managed 60+ SKUs on Swiggy Minis and built a custom Excel-based WIP tracker to manage catalog listings, order tracking, and inventory visibility, reducing catalog errors by 90% and improving stock flow for fast-selling styles.
- Produced 25+ branded content assets and launched 3+ Instagram ad campaigns, improving click-through rates by 22% through A/B testing and targeted messaging.

Assistant Fashion Manager Go Colors (Go Fashion India Ltd.), Chennai, India Sept 2020 - June 2023

Supported buying and merchandising for women's and girls' bottom-wear categories including leggings, track pants, formal pants, ethnic bottoms, and shorts, with responsibility for vendor coordination, product lifecycle execution, and data-led assortment decisions.

- Managed PO/PI coordination and vendor communication across 20+ suppliers and 10+ factories across India and Asia, ensuring 95% on-time delivery for seasonal production orders.
- Analyzed weekly sales performance for 200+ SKUs, recommending replenishment and assortment adjustments that improved category sell-through by 15%.
- Aligned assortment planning with trend insights and performance data, driving a 10% lift in customer purchase rate across key bottom-wear categories.
- Launched 3+ new sub-categories including kids-wear, leading a 2-member team to introduce new styles and revamp existing collections, boosting category sales by 15% in the first quarter.
- Negotiated supplier pricing and MOQs during fabric sourcing and production planning, maintaining product quality while ensuring competitive margins.
- Led sampling, fit approvals, and production coordination for 30+ styles per season, reducing post-launch return rates to under 10% while gaining exposure to PLM-driven product development workflows.
- Built WIP trackers to monitor production timelines and collaborated with logistics, VM, and marketing teams to ensure timely product launches.